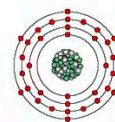


34

Se

Selenium



State: Solid

Discovery: 1817

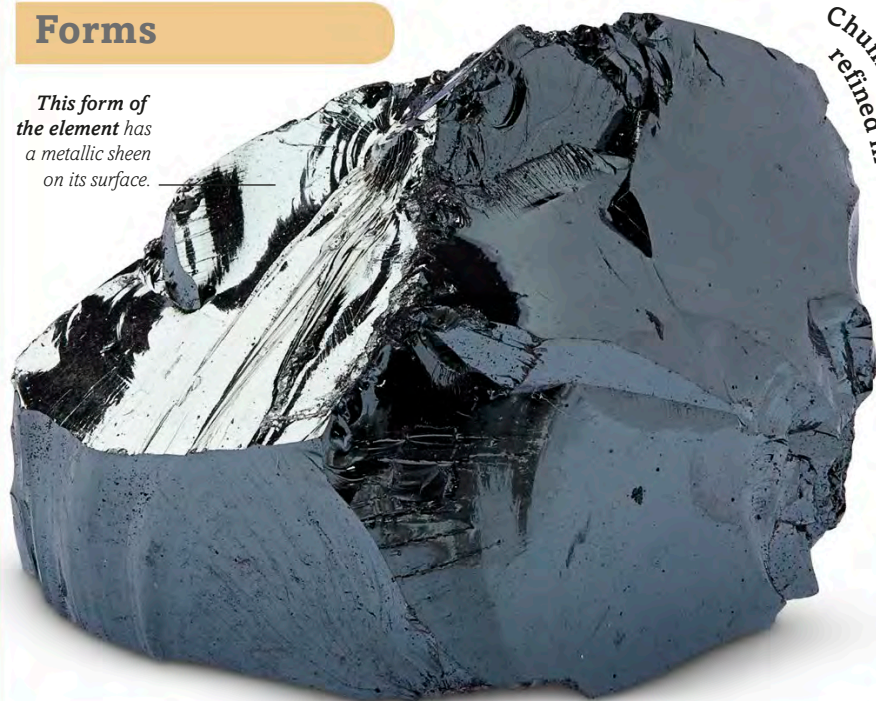
- 34

+ 34

- 45

Forms

This form of the element has a metallic sheen on its surface.



Chunk of pure grey selenium refined in a laboratory

Brazil nuts

These nuts are the richest food source of selenium.



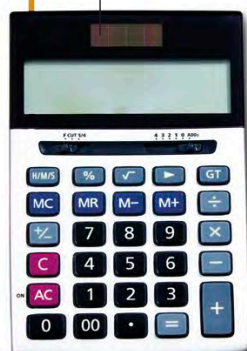
These dark areas contain selenium and copper.

Berzelianite



Uses

This calculator is powered by a solar cell made of selenium and nickel.



Calculator

Anti-dandruff shampoo



This bright colour comes from the red selenium in the glaze.

Ceramic vase



A selenium compound in this shampoo treats dandruff.

Photocopier



Many office photocopiers use selenium in powdered form.

Selenium is named after Selene, the Greek goddess of the Moon. This element is a semi-metal and so has the properties of both metals and non-metals. Selenium has two main pure forms: **grey selenium**, which is a hard substance, and red selenium, which is a soft

powder. The most common use of selenium is as an ingredient that provides colour in glass and **ceramics**. Selenium is sensitive to light, so it is used in solar cells that convert sunlight into electricity. It is also utilized in **photocopy machines**.